Theme 5 title 3 child edition

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THE SECRET HERO
How Joseph, David, and Jonah Point to Jesus
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A Note for Parents

Have you ever had a secret? A really good secret? Maybe a surprise party. Maybe a special gift. Maybe a hidden treasure. You knew something exciting was coming. You could not wait to share it. But you had to wait. The Old Testament is like a big secret. God knew something exciting was coming. He knew a Hero was coming. He knew Jesus was coming. He could not wait to share it. So He left clues. He left secrets. He left heroes. These heroes are the secret heroes. They are hidden in the Old Testament. And every single one of them points to Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to uncover the secret heroes. We are going to find the hidden clues. We are going to discover the greatest secret of all. That secret is Jesus. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to put on your detective hats. Get ready to uncover the secrets. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: Joseph the Beloved Son

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Now Israel loved Joseph more than any of his other sons, because he had been born to him in his old age; and he made an ornate robe for him." - Genesis 37:3

Joseph was a secret hero. He was the beloved son. His father loved him more than his other sons. He gave him an ornate robe. He gave him a special gift. He gave him a special place. Joseph was the beloved son. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is my Son, whom I love; with him I am well pleased." - Matthew 3:17

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He is the beloved Son. He is the Son of the Father. He is the one whom the Father loves. He is the one with whom the Father is well pleased. Joseph was the beloved son. Jesus is the beloved Son. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a father and a son. Write the name "Jesus" above them. Talk about how God loves Jesus, and how God loves you too.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for loving me. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me your child. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A father and a son holding hands with a big heart above them.

Day 02: Joseph the Dreamer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He said to them, 'Listen to this dream I had: We were binding sheaves of grain out in the field when suddenly my sheaf rose and stood upright, while your sheaves gathered around mine and bowed down to it.'" - Genesis 37:6-7

Joseph was a secret hero. He was a dreamer. He had dreams. He had visions. He saw the future. He saw his brothers bowing down to him. He saw his family bowing down to him. Joseph was a dreamer. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He is the dreamer. He is the one who saw the future. He is the one who saw the nations bowing down to Him. He is the one who came to seek and save. Joseph was a dreamer. Jesus is the dreamer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a dream. Clouds. Stars. A big imagination. Write the name "Jesus" in the dream. Talk about how Jesus has a dream for your life.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for having a dream for my life. Help me to follow your dream. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person sleeping with a dream bubble above them full of stars.

Day 03: Joseph the Rejected Brother

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But when his brothers saw that their father loved him more than any of them, they hated him and could not speak a kind word to him." - Genesis 37:4

Joseph was a secret hero. He was rejected. His brothers hated him. They could not speak a kind word to him. They were jealous. They were angry. They rejected him. Joseph was the rejected brother. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He came to that which was his own, but his own did not receive him." - John 1:11

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was rejected. He came to his own. He came to his people. But they did not receive him. They rejected him. Joseph was rejected. Jesus was rejected. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a sad face. Then draw a big smile next to it. Talk about how Jesus was rejected, but He still loves us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for loving me even when others reject me. Help me to forgive those who reject me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A sad face turning into a happy face with a big heart.

Day 04: Joseph the Sold Slave

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So when the Midianite merchants came by, his brothers pulled Joseph up out of the cistern and sold him for twenty shekels of silver to the Ishmaelites, who took him to Egypt." - Genesis 37:28

Joseph was a secret hero. He was sold. His brothers sold him. They sold him as a slave. They sold him for twenty shekels of silver. Joseph was the sold slave. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Then one of the Twelve—the one called Judas Iscariot—went to the chief priests and asked, 'What are you willing to give me if I deliver him over to you?' So they counted out for him thirty pieces of silver." - Matthew 26:14-15

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was sold. He was sold by Judas. He was sold for thirty pieces of silver. Joseph was sold. Jesus was sold. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Count out some coins. Put them in a small bag. Talk about how Joseph was sold as a slave, and how Jesus was sold too. But Jesus did it to save us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being sold for me. Thank you for loving me that much. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A small bag with coins spilling out and a big heart.

Day 05: Joseph the Faithful Servant

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD was with Joseph so that he prospered, and he lived in the house of his Egyptian master." - Genesis 39:2

Joseph was a secret hero. He was a faithful servant. He was sold as a slave. He was taken to Egypt. But he was faithful. He worked hard. He served well. He prospered. God was with him. Joseph was the faithful servant. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many." - Mark 10:45

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was a faithful servant. He did not come to be served. He came to serve. He came to give his life. Joseph was a faithful servant. Jesus is the faithful servant. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of one way you can serve someone this week. Write it down. Ask God to help you do it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for serving me. Help me to serve others. Help me to be faithful. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two hands washing each other with a big heart between them.

Day 06: Joseph the Falsely Accused

The Secret Clue (OT)
"When his master heard the story his wife told him, saying, 'This is how your slave treated me,' he burned with anger. Joseph's master took him and put him in prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined." - Genesis 39:19-20

Joseph was a secret hero. He was falsely accused. He was accused of something he did not do. He was innocent. But he was accused. He was arrested. He was put in prison. Joseph was the falsely accused. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to empathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet he did not sin." - Hebrews 4:15

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was falsely accused. He was accused of something he did not do. He was innocent. But he was accused. He was arrested. He was put on trial. Joseph was falsely accused. Jesus was falsely accused. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a prison cell. Then draw a big open door. Talk about how Joseph was in prison, but God was with him. Talk about how Jesus was falsely accused too.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being falsely accused for me. Thank you for understanding my pain. Help me to forgive those who accuse me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A prison cell with an open door and a bright light shining in.

Day 07: Joseph the Forgotten Prisoner

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But when all goes well with you, remember me and show me kindness; mention me to Pharaoh and get me out of this prison." - Genesis 40:14

Joseph was a secret hero. He was forgotten. He helped a fellow prisoner. He interpreted his dream. He asked him to remember him. But the prisoner forgot him. Joseph was the forgotten prisoner. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Why are you so far from saving me, so far from my cries of anguish?" - Psalm 22:1

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was forgotten. He was forsaken. He cried out on the cross. He felt abandoned. He felt alone. Joseph was forgotten. Jesus was forgotten. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lonely person. Then draw a big friend next to them. Talk about how Joseph felt forgotten, but God never forgot him. Talk about how Jesus felt forsaken, but God never left him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for never forgetting me. Thank you, Jesus, for being with me always. Help me to trust you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A lonely person with a big friend hugging them and a big smile.

Day 08: Joseph the Dream Interpreter

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'I had a dream, and no one can interpret it. But I have heard it said of you that when you hear a dream you can interpret it.'" - Genesis 41:15

Joseph was a secret hero. He was a dream interpreter. He interpreted dreams. He interpreted the dreams of Pharaoh. He revealed the future. He saved a nation. Joseph was the dream interpreter. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He reveals deep and hidden things; he knows what lies in darkness, and light dwells with him." - Daniel 2:22

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He is the dream interpreter. He reveals deep and hidden things. He knows what lies in darkness. He knows the future. Joseph was a dream interpreter. Jesus is the dream interpreter. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a crystal ball. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus knows the future. He knows everything.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for knowing the future. Thank you for knowing everything. Help me to trust your plan. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A glowing crystal ball with a big heart inside it.

Day 09: Joseph the Exalted Ruler

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'Since God has made all this known to you, there is no one so discerning and wise as you. You shall be in charge of my palace, and all my people are to submit to your orders. Only with respect to the throne will I be greater than you.'" - Genesis 41:39-40

Joseph was a secret hero. He was exalted. He was raised up. He was made a ruler. He was put in charge. He was second in command. Joseph was the exalted ruler. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Therefore God exalted him to the highest place and gave him the name that is above every name..." - Philippians 2:9

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was exalted. He was raised up. He was made King. He was given a name above every name. Joseph was exalted. Jesus was exalted. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Put it on your child's head. Talk about how Joseph was exalted, and how Jesus is the King of Kings.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the King. Thank you for exalting me. Help me to live as a child of the King. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big golden crown with a big smile on it.

Day 10: Joseph the Forgiver

The Secret Clue (OT)

"But Joseph said to them, 'Do not be afraid. Am I in the place of God? You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of many lives.'" - Genesis 50:19-20

Joseph was a secret hero. He was a forgiver. He forgave his brothers. He forgave them for selling him. He forgave them for hurting him. He forgave them for rejecting him. Joseph was the forgiver. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Jesus said, 'Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.'" - Luke 23:34

Jesus is the greater Joseph. He was a forgiver. He forgave his enemies. He forgave them for crucifying him. He forgave them for hurting him. Joseph was a forgiver. Jesus is the forgiver. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of someone you need to forgive. Write their name down. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for forgiving me. Help me to forgive others. Help me to love others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a bandage on it and a big smile.

Day 11: David the Shepherd Boy

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But David said to Saul, 'Your servant has been keeping his father's sheep. When a lion or a bear came and carried off a sheep from the flock, I went after it, struck it and rescued the sheep from its mouth...'" - 1 Samuel 17:34-35

David was a secret hero. He was a shepherd boy. He kept his father's sheep. He protected them. He rescued them. David was the shepherd boy. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

Jesus is the greater David. He is the shepherd. He is the good shepherd. He keeps his father's sheep. He protects them. He rescues them. He lays down his life. David was a shepherd boy. Jesus is the shepherd. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity

Draw a picture of a shepherd with a sheep. Write the name "Jesus" above the shepherd. Thank Him for being your Good Shepherd.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Good Shepherd. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for rescuing me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shepherd holding a fluffy lamb with a big smile.

Day 12: David the Anointed King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So Samuel took the horn of oil and anointed him in the presence of his brothers, and from that day on the Spirit of the LORD came powerfully upon David." - 1 Samuel 16:13

David was a secret hero. He was anointed. He was anointed by Samuel. He was chosen by God. He was set apart as king. David was the anointed king. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor..." - Luke 4:18

Jesus is the greater David. He was anointed. He was anointed by the Spirit. He was chosen by God. He was set apart as King. David was anointed. Jesus is the anointed. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Put a drop of oil on your child's finger. Talk about how David was anointed with oil, and how Jesus was anointed with the Spirit.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the anointed King. Thank you for choosing me. Help me to live as your chosen child. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A horn of oil with a big heart and a crown.

Day 13: David the Giant Slayer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"David said to the Philistine, 'You come against me with sword and spear and javelin, but I come against you in the name of the LORD Almighty...'" - 1 Samuel 17:45

David was a secret hero. He was a giant slayer. He faced Goliath. He faced the giant. He faced the fear. He defeated him. David was the giant slayer. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And having disarmed the powers and authorities, he made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross." - Colossians 2:15

Jesus is the greater David. He was a giant slayer. He faced sin. He faced death. He faced the devil. He defeated them. David was a giant slayer. Jesus is the giant slayer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big giant. Then draw a small boy with a sling. Talk about how David defeated the giant, and how Jesus defeated sin and death.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for defeating the giant. Thank you for defeating sin and death. Help me to face my giants. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A small boy with a sling facing a big giant with a big smile.

Day 14: David the Rejected King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or his height, for I have rejected him. The LORD does not look at the things people look at. People look at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart.'" - 1 Samuel 16:7

David was a secret hero. He was rejected. He was rejected by his brothers. They did not believe in him. They did not support him. He was overlooked. He was dismissed. David was the rejected king. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He came to that which was his own, but his own did not receive him." - John 1:11

Jesus is the greater David. He was rejected. He came to his own. He came to his people. But they did not receive him. They rejected him. David was rejected. Jesus was rejected. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a heart. Write the name "Jesus" inside it. Talk about how God looks at the heart, not the outside.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for looking at my heart. Thank you for loving me. Help me to love others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a smile inside it.

Day 15: David the Worshiper

The Secret Clue (OT)
"David, wearing a linen ephod, danced before the LORD with all his might..." - 2 Samuel 6:14

David was a secret hero. He was a worshiper. He danced before the Lord. He sang to the Lord. He praised the Lord. He worshiped with all his might. David was the worshiper. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And when they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives." - Matthew 26:30

Jesus is the greater David. He was a worshiper. He sang to the Lord. He praised the Lord. He worshiped with all his heart. David was a worshiper. Jesus is the worshiper. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on a favorite worship song. Sing along. Dance if you want to. Thank Jesus for being worthy of worship.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being worthy of worship. Help me to worship you. Help me to praise you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A musical note with a big heart and a big smile.

Day 16: David the Sinner

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then David said to Nathan, 'I have sinned against the LORD.' Nathan replied, 'The LORD has taken away your sin. You are not going to die.'" - 2 Samuel 12:13

David was a secret hero. He was a sinner. He sinned. He committed adultery. He committed murder. He messed up. He failed. But he repented. He confessed. He was forgiven. David was the sinner. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness." - 1 John 1:9

Jesus is the greater David. He is the forgiver. He forgives sins. He purifies. He cleanses. David was a sinner. Jesus is the forgiver. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Confess it to God. Thank Jesus for forgiving you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for forgiving my sins. Help me to confess my sins. Help me to receive your forgiveness. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a cross and a big smile inside it.

Day 17: David the Man After God's Heart

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But now your kingdom will not endure; the LORD has sought out a man after his own heart and appointed him ruler of his people..." - 1 Samuel 13:14

David was a secret hero. He was a man after God's heart. He was called a man after God's own heart. He loved God. He followed God. He pursued God. David was the man after God's heart. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I will be a Father to him, and he will be my Son." - Hebrews 1:5

Jesus is the greater David. He was the Son of God. He was the Son of the Father. He was the one after God's heart. David was a man after God's heart. Jesus is the Son after God's heart. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Write down one way you can pursue God this week. Write it down. Ask God to help you do it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for loving me. Help me to pursue you. Help me to be a person after your heart. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross and a shining star above it.

Day 18: David the Temple Preparer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"David said, 'My son Solomon is young and inexperienced, and the house to be built for the LORD should be of great magnificence and fame and splendor in the sight of all the nations. Therefore I will make preparations for it.' So David made extensive preparations before his death." - 1 Chronicles 22:5

David was a secret hero. He was a temple preparer. He prepared the temple. He prepared the house for God. He prepared the materials. He prepared the plans. David was the temple preparer. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I saw the Holy City, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride beautifully dressed for her husband." - Revelation 21:2

Jesus is the greater David. He is the temple preparer. He prepared a temple. He prepared a house. He prepared a city. He prepared a home. David was a temple preparer. Jesus is the temple preparer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a beautiful house. Write the name "Jesus" on the door. Talk about how Jesus is preparing a home for us in heaven.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for preparing a home for me. Thank you for the beautiful city. Help me to look forward to heaven. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful house with a big heart on the door and a big smile.

Day 19: David the King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the men of Judah came to Hebron and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah." - 2 Samuel 2:4

David was a secret hero. He was a king. He was anointed king. He was made king. He ruled the people. He led the nation. David was the king. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name..." - Philippians 2:9

Jesus is the greater David. He is the King. He is the King of Kings. He is the Lord of Lords. He is the one who was exalted. He is the one who was given a name above every name. David was a king. Jesus is the King. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Put it on your child's head. Say, "You are a child of the King." Thank Jesus for being your King.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my King. Thank you for ruling me. Thank you for leading me. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big golden crown with a big heart on it.

Day 20: Jonah the Reluctant

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But Jonah ran away from the LORD and headed for Tarshish. He went down to Joppa, where he found a ship bound for that port. After paying the fare, he went aboard and sailed for Tarshish to flee from the LORD." - Jonah 1:3

Jonah was a secret hero. He was reluctant. He was called by God. He was called to preach to Nineveh. But he ran away. He fled. He was reluctant. But God used him anyway. Jonah was the reluctant. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." - Matthew 12:40

Jesus is the greater Jonah. Jonah ran away. Jesus obeyed. Jonah was in the fish for three days. Jesus was in the tomb for three days. Jonah was a reluctant rescuer. Jesus is the ultimate rescuer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big fish. Write the name "Jesus" inside the fish. Talk about how Jonah was in the fish for three days, and how Jesus was in the tomb for three days.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being in the tomb for three days. Thank you for rising again. Help me to obey you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big fish with a man inside and a big smile.

Day 21: Jonah the Preacher

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Jonah began by going a day's journey into the city, proclaiming, 'Forty more days and Nineveh will be overthrown.'" - Jonah 3:4

Jonah was a secret hero. He was a preacher. He preached to Nineveh. He preached repentance. He preached judgment. He was a preacher. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"From that time on Jesus began to preach, 'Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.'" - Matthew 4:17

Jesus is the greater Jonah. He was a preacher. He preached to the people. He preached repentance. He preached the kingdom. Jonah was a preacher. Jesus is the preacher. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Stand on a chair. Pretend to be a preacher. Say, "Repent! The kingdom of heaven is near!" Talk about how Jonah preached, and how Jesus preached too.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for preaching the kingdom. Thank you for the good news. Help me to share the good news. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person speaking with a big heart and a big smile.

Day 22: Jonah the Rescuer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"When Jonah's warning reached the king of Nineveh, he rose from his throne, took off his royal robes, covered himself with sackcloth and sat down in the dust." - Jonah 3:6

Jonah was a secret hero. He was a rescuer. He rescued Nineveh. He preached. The people repented. God forgave them. Jonah was the rescuer. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the greater Jonah. He was a rescuer. He came to seek. He came to save. He came to rescue. Jonah was a rescuer. Jesus is the rescuer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a city. Write the name "Jesus" over the city. Talk about how Jonah saved Nineveh, and how Jesus saves the world.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for saving the world. Thank you for saving me. Help me to share your love. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big city with a big heart above it.

Day 23: Jonah the Angry

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But to Jonah this seemed very wrong, and he became angry." - Jonah 4:1

Jonah was a secret hero. He was angry. He was angry that God forgave Nineveh. He was angry that God showed mercy. He was angry. But God was patient. God was kind. God taught him a lesson. Jonah was the angry. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"But God demonstrates his own love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." - Romans 5:8

Jesus is the greater Jonah. Jonah was angry. Jesus was loving. Jonah was reluctant. Jesus was willing. Jonah was a reluctant rescuer. Jesus is the ultimate rescuer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of an angry face. Then draw a big smile next to it. Talk about how God is patient with us, even when we are angry.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for being patient with me. Help me to not be angry. Help me to love others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A grumpy face turning into a happy face with a big heart.

Day 24: Jonah the Sign

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He answered, 'A wicked and adulterous generation asks for a sign! But none will be given it except the sign of the prophet Jonah.'" - Matthew 12:39

Jonah was a secret hero. He was a sign. He was a sign to the people. He was a sign of three days. He was a sign of resurrection. Jonah was the sign. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." - Matthew 12:40

Jesus is the greater Jonah. He is the sign. He is the sign of three days. He is the sign of resurrection. Jonah was the sign. Jesus is the sign. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a tomb. Draw a big stone rolled away. Write the word "Alive!" Talk about how Jonah was a sign, and how Jesus is the sign of resurrection.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for rising from the dead. Thank you for the sign. Help me to believe. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An empty tomb with a big sunrise and a big smile.

Day 25: Jonah the Obedient

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the word of the LORD came to Jonah a second time: 'Go to the great city of Nineveh and proclaim to it the message I give you.' Jonah obeyed the word of the LORD and went to Nineveh." - Jonah 3:1-3

Jonah was a secret hero. He was obedient. He was called by God. He ran away. But God gave him a second chance. He obeyed. He went. He preached. Jonah was the obedient. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death—even death on a cross!" - Philippians 2:8

Jesus is the greater Jonah. He was obedient. He obeyed the Father. He went to the cross. Jonah was obedient. Jesus is obedient. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a time you disobeyed. Write it down. Ask God for a second chance. Thank Jesus for obeying for you.

Kid's Prayer
*"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying for me

……

Day 25: Jonah the Obedient (Continued)

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying for me. Thank you for giving me a second chance. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person walking on a path with a big smile and a bright light ahead.

Day 26: David the Shepherd King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And the LORD said to Samuel, 'Rise and anoint him; this is the one.' So Samuel took the horn of oil and anointed him in the presence of his brothers, and from that day on the Spirit of the LORD came powerfully upon David." - 1 Samuel 16:12-13

David was a secret hero. He was a shepherd. He was a king. He was a shepherd king. He cared for the sheep. He cared for the people. He led them. He protected them. David was the shepherd king. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

Jesus is the greater David. He is the shepherd. He is the king. He is the shepherd king. He cares for the sheep. He cares for the people. He leads them. He protects them. He lays down his life. David was a shepherd king. Jesus is the shepherd king. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a shepherd with a crown. Write the name "Jesus" above him. Talk about how Jesus is both our shepherd and our king.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my shepherd and my king. Thank you for leading me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shepherd with a crown holding a fluffy lamb with a big smile.

Day 27: David the Temple Preparer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"David said, 'My son Solomon is young and inexperienced, and the house to be built for the LORD should be of great magnificence and fame and splendor in the sight of all the nations. Therefore I will make preparations for it.' So David made extensive preparations before his death." - 1 Chronicles 22:5

David was a secret hero. He was a temple preparer. He prepared the temple. He prepared the house for God. He prepared the materials. He prepared the plans. David was the temple preparer. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I saw the Holy City, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride beautifully dressed for her husband." - Revelation 21:2

Jesus is the greater David. He is the temple preparer. He prepared a temple. He prepared a house. He prepared a city. He prepared a home. David was a temple preparer. Jesus is the temple preparer. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a beautiful house. Write the name "Jesus" on the door. Talk about how Jesus is preparing a home for us in heaven.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for preparing a home for me. Thank you for the beautiful city. Help me to look forward to heaven. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful house with a big heart on the door and a big smile.

Day 28: David the King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the men of Judah came to Hebron and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah." - 2 Samuel 2:4

David was a secret hero. He was a king. He was anointed king. He was made king. He ruled the people. He led the nation. David was the king. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name..." - Philippians 2:9

Jesus is the greater David. He is the King. He is the King of Kings. He is the Lord of Lords. He is the one who was exalted. He is the one who was given a name above every name.

David was a king. Jesus is the King. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Put it on your child's head. Say, "You are a child of the King." Thank Jesus for being your King.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my King. Thank you for ruling me. Thank you for leading me. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big golden crown with a big heart on it.

Day 29: Jonah the Sign

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He answered, 'A wicked and adulterous generation asks for a sign! But none will be given it except the sign of the prophet Jonah.'" - Matthew 12:39

Jonah was a secret hero. He was a sign. He was a sign to the people. He was a sign of three days. He was a sign of resurrection. Jonah was the sign. And he is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." - Matthew 12:40

Jesus is the greater Jonah. He is the sign. He is the sign of three days. He is the sign of resurrection. Jonah was the sign. Jesus is the sign. The pattern is exact. The secret is out. The hero is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a tomb. Draw a big stone rolled away. Write the word "Alive!" Talk about how Jonah was a sign, and how Jesus is the sign of resurrection.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for rising from the dead. Thank you for the sign. Help me to believe. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An empty tomb with a big sunrise and a big smile.

Day 30: The Secret Hero

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was said in all the Scriptures concerning himself." - Luke 24:27

Joseph was a secret hero. David was a secret hero. Jonah was a secret hero. They were all secret heroes. They were all shadows. They were all clues. They were all patterns. And they all pointed to the ultimate secret hero. That hero is Jesus. He is the one who was hidden in the Old Testament. He is the one who was promised. He is the one who came. He is the secret hero.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the secret hero. He is the one who came to seek. He is the one who came to save. He is the one who came to rescue. He is the fulfillment of Joseph. He is the fulfillment of David. He is the fulfillment of Jonah. He is the secret hero.

Family Activity
Write down one thing you have learned about the secret hero over the last 30 days. Thank God for the secret hero. Thank Him for Jesus.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for Joseph. Thank you for David. Thank you for Jonah. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for the secret hero. Help me to trust the hero. Help me to follow the hero. Help me to live in the rescue of the hero. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big treasure chest with a cross and a big smile inside it.

END MATTER

The "Secret Hero" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Secret Hero adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Secret Hero Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was your favorite secret hero from this book?
Card 2: What was the coolest clue you found?
Card 3: Why do you think God hid so many clues about Jesus?

Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is the secret hero?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days uncovering the secret hero with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Old Testament Detective

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Old Testament Detective takes you on a journey through 30 days of finding clues about Jesus in the heroes. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, glowing storybook with pictures of Joseph, David, and Jonah on it. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title THE SECRET HERO is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word SECRET is in bright red with a magnifying glass replacing the letter S. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.